

Teacher's Guide: *Uncovering the Logic of English Curriculum*

How to Use This Curriculum

You're the teacher. Here's everything you need in one place.

Quick Start (5 Minutes)

1. **Read** `curriculum.md` — the full scope, sequence, and methodology (55KB reference)
2. **Print** the phonogram chart: `reference/phonogram-chart.html`
3. **Print** the spelling rules: `reference/spelling-rules.html`
4. **Open** your stage's lesson files in `lessons/stage-X/`
5. **Generate PDFs:** `python framework/render.py --stage 1`

That's it. Everything else is in the lesson files.

What's Where

Folder/File	What It Is	When to Use
<code>curriculum.md</code>	Full 55KB master reference	Read once before starting
<code>lessons/stage-1/</code>	48 Pre-K lessons (age 4-5)	Start here
<code>lessons/stage-2/</code>	56 Kindergarten lessons (age 5-6)	After Stage 1 mastery

Folder/File	What It Is	When to Use
lessons/stage-3/	56 Grade 1 lessons (age 6-7)	After Stage 2 mastery
lessons/stage-4/	48 Grade 2 lessons (age 7-8)	After Stage 3 mastery
lessons/stage-5/	40 Grade 3+ lessons (age 8+)	After Stage 4 mastery
reference/quickstart.html	One-page cheat sheet	Print and keep on wall
reference/phonogram-chart.html	All 75 phonograms with sounds	Daily flash review
reference/spelling-rules.html	All 31 rules with examples	Reference during spelling analysis
reference/spelling-analysis.html	5-step routine poster	Print for lesson area
reference/word-lists.html	Decodable word lists by pattern	Extra practice
reference/high-frequency-words.html	HF words with explanations	Reference
reference/troubleshooting.html	Common problems + fixes	When stuck
reference/morpheme-wall.html	Latin/Greek roots display	Stage 4-5
TEACHER-GUIDE.md	This document	Start here
TEACHER-GUIDE.pdf	Printable version of this guide	Print once
framework/render.py	MD→PDF converter	Generate printable lesson PDFs

Folder/File	What It Is	When to Use
framework/image-check.py	Image inventory tool	Check missing images
assets/main.css	Stylesheet for HTML references	Already linked in all HTMLs

Cross-Reference Map

How the documents connect:

TEACHER-GUIDE.md ← START HERE

```

├─ curriculum.md ← Full methodology reference
|   └─ Stage 1-5 sections ← Scope & sequence per stage
|       └─ Complete Phonogram List (75)
|       └─ Complete Spelling Rules (31)
|       └─ Phonogram-Rule Mapping
|
├─ reference/ ← Printable classroom aids
|   └─ quickstart.html ← One-page cheat sheet
|   └─ phonogram-chart.html ← All 75 PGs on one page
|   └─ spelling-rules.html ← All 31 rules
|   └─ spelling-analysis.html ← 5-step routine poster
|   └─ word-lists.html ← Decodable word banks
|   └─ high-frequency-words.html ← HF words explained
|   └─ troubleshooting.html ← Common issues + fixes
|   └─ morpheme-wall.html ← Roots for Stages 4-5
|
├─ lessons/ ← 248 lesson files (the actual curriculum)
|   └─ stage-1/ (48 files) Pre-K
|   └─ stage-2/ (56 files) Kindergarten

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```
|      |— stage-3/  (56 files)  Grade 1
|      |— stage-4/  (48 files)  Grade 2
|      |— stage-5/  (40 files)  Grade 3+
|
|— framework/  ← Tools
    |— render.py  ← MD → PDF
    |— generate.py ← Stub generator
    |— image-check.py ← Image inventory
    |— image-manifest.csv ← All planned images
    |— lesson-catalog.csv ← 248-lesson index
```

Stage-by-Stage Overview

Stage 1: Phonemic Awareness & First Phonograms (48 lessons, Pre-K)

Before starting: Child should speak in complete sentences, follow two-step directions, and hold a pencil.

What you do each lesson (15-20 minutes):

Step	Time	Activity
1	2 min	Phonogram flash review (say ALL sounds)
2	5 min	Introduce new phonogram OR phonemic awareness game
3	5 min	Writing practice / sand tray
4	3 min	Review + quick check

Lesson types in Stage 1:

Lessons	Type	Description
1-8	Phonemic awareness	Environmental sounds, blending, segmenting — NO letters yet
9-14	Group 1 phonograms	a, d, g, c, o, qu — clockface letters
15	Review	Group 1 review game
16-21	Group 2 phonograms	s, t, i, p, u, j — straight-start letters
22	Review	Group 2 review game
23	PA check-in	Final sounds in words
24-29	Group 3 phonograms	r, n, m, e, l, b — loops and bumps
30	Review	Group 3 review game
31	PA check-in	Middle sounds in words
32-37	Group 4 phonograms	h, k, f, v, w, x — tall/diagonal
38	Review	Group 4 review game
39-40	Group 5 phonograms	y, z — final group
41	PA check-in	Sound swapping game
42	Concept	Meet the vowels
43	Review	All 26 phonograms review
44-45	PA check-in	Blends + two-syllable blending
46-47	Handwriting	Clockface + straight-start letter formation

Lessons	Type	Description
48	Assessment	Stage 1 mastery check

Materials to prepare: Phonogram cards for a-z (text-based — print from any phonogram lesson), sand tray or whiteboard, letter formation guide.

When to move on: Child says all a-z sounds within 2 seconds, segments/blends CVC words orally, identifies initial/final/medial sounds.

Stage 2: CVC Words & First Multi-Letter Phonograms (56 lessons, K)

Before starting: Child has mastered all Stage 1 assessment items.

What you do each lesson (25-35 minutes):

Step	Time	Activity
1	5 min	Phonogram flash review (a-z + multi-letter learned so far)
2	5 min	Phonemic awareness drill (blending/segmenting)
3	2 min	Introduce new phonogram (if scheduled)
4	10 min	Spelling Analysis: 3-5 words
5	5 min	Read decodable words/sentences
6	3 min	Handwriting or dictation

Lesson types in Stage 2:

Lessons	Type	Description
1	Review	Review Stage 1 phonograms

Lessons	Type	Description
2-6	Short vowels	One short vowel per lesson: a, i, o, u, e
7-10	Word building	VC → CVC continuant → CVC stop → all CVC
11-13	Multi-letter PGs	sh, th, ck + Rule 26
14	Spelling analysis	Practice sh/th/ck words
15	Multi-letter PG	ee
16-18	Consonant blends	CCVC, CVCC, CCVCC
19-22	Multi-letter PGs	ng, ar, or, er
23	Review	First 8 multi-letter PGs
24	Assessment	Mid-Stage 2 check
25-30	Multi-letter PGs + Rules	oi, oy, ai, ay + Rules 3, 9
31	Spelling analysis	oi/oy/ai/ay practice
32-38	Multi-letter PGs + Rule 4	ch, wh, ea, ow, ou
39	Word building	Open syllable words (Rule 4)
40-47	Multi-letter PGs + Rules	oo, ed, igh, aw, au, ir, ur + Rule 20, 28
48	Review	Second wave multi-letter PGs
49-50	Multi-letter PGs	oa, ear
51-53	HF words	Sets 1-3 (15 words with explanations)
54	Rule	Rule 30: Floss Rule
55	Reader	Fred the Frog
56	Assessment	Stage 2 mastery check

Materials to prepare: All a-z phonogram cards + multi-letter PG cards (sh, th, ck, ee, etc.), whiteboard, spelling analysis chart.

Key rules introduced: 26 (CK), 3 (No I/U/V/J), 9 (AY at end), 4 (Long at end), 20 (-ED), 28 (GH), 30 (Floss).

Stage 3: Silent E & Vowel Teams (56 lessons, Grade 1)

What you do each lesson (30-40 minutes):

Step	Time	Activity
1	5 min	Phonogram flash review (all 75)
2	5 min	Phonemic awareness (multi-syllable blending)
3	3 min	New concept (phonogram or rule)
4	12 min	Spelling Analysis: 4-6 words
5	7 min	Decodable reading (sentences or short book)
6	3 min	Dictation

Lesson types in Stage 3:

Lessons	Type	Description
1-2	Review + concept	Stage 2 review, long vowel sounds
3-6	Silent E 12.1-12.4	Vowel long, no V/U, C→/s/ G→/j/, syllable needs vowel
7	Review	SE 12.1-12.4 review
8-12	Silent E 12.5-12.9	Not plural, look bigger, TH voiced, clarify meaning, unseen reason

Lessons	Type	Description
13	Practice	Name that reason (all 9 SE reasons)
14-16	Rules 1-2 + spelling	C softens, G softens, ce/ci/ge/gi practice
17-19	PGs + review	dge, tch + Rule 25/27 review
20-23	Silent letter PGs	kn, gn, wr + review
24	Assessment	Mid-Stage 3 check
25-32	PGs + Rule 28	eigh, ei, ey, ph, gh, ough, augh
33-35	PGs	ew, ui, eu
36-40	Rules 5-8, 10	I/Y at end, Y=/ī/, I/Y=/ē/, I/O before 2 consonants, A=/ä/
41-42	PGs	wor, ie
43-46	Syllable division	Compound, VCCV, VCV, C+LE
47	Rule 31	Schwa introduction
48-49	Readers	Gwen Gives a Gift, Cole and His Bike
50	Spelling	Mixed Stage 3 spelling analysis
51-52	Reviews	All Stage 3 PGs + rules
53-54	HF words	Sets 4-5 (10 words)
55	Reader	The Sail Box
56	Assessment	Stage 3 mastery check

Key new concept: Say-to-Spell. Introduced at Lesson 47 (schwa), used throughout Stage 3 for all multi-syllable words.

Stage 4: Suffixing, Latin /sh/ & Morphology (48 lessons, Grade 2)

What you do each lesson (35-45 minutes):

Step	Time	Activity
1	5 min	Phonogram flash review
2	5 min	Say-to-Spell drill
3	5 min	New concept
4	15 min	Spelling Analysis + practice
5	10 min	Reading + writing application

Lesson types in Stage 4:

Lessons	Type	Description
1	Review	Stage 3 review
2-7	Schwa deep dive	31.1, say-to-spell, multi-syllable, 31.2, 31.3, mastery
8-12	Suffixing 13-14	Drop E, double consonant + practice + review
13	Assessment	Mid-Stage 4 check
14-17	Suffixing 15-16	Y→I, two I's + review
18-23	Latin /sh/	ti, ci, si + Rules 17-18 + mastery
24-33	Morphology	4 prefix pairs, 6 suffix pairs
34-39	Rules 23-24, 19, 21-22, 29	AL- prefix, -FUL suffix, past tense, plurals
40-41	Irregular forms	Verbs + plurals
42-43	Readers	Firefly, Trains

Lessons	Type	Description
44-45	Reviews	Morpheme reviews: prefixes + suffixes
46	Spelling	Mixed Stage 4 spelling
47-48	Review + assessment	Global review + mastery check

Stage 5: Roots, Fluency & Composition (40 lessons, Grade 3+)

What you do each lesson (40-50 minutes):

Step	Time	Activity
1	5 min	Phonogram speed flash
2	10 min	Root introduction + word building
3	10 min	Spelling analysis with root words
4	10 min	Fluency or composition practice
5	5 min	Quick check + review

Lesson types in Stage 5:

Lessons	Type	Description
1	Review	Stage 4 review
2-13	12 Latin roots	dict, duct, spect, port, form, struct, rupt, ject, tract, scrib, mit/miss, vid/vis
14	Review	Latin roots review
15-24	10 Greek roots	graph, phon, bio, geo, therm, meter, scope, auto/tele, micro/chron, photo/logy

Lessons	Type	Description
25-26	Reviews	Greek roots review + all 25 roots review
27-29	Vocabulary	Tier 2 words, synonyms/antonyms, word relationships
30-32	Fluency	Repeated reading, phrasing/expression, reading rate
33-35	Composition	Sentence building, paragraph writing, spelling in writing
36-38	Grammar	Parts of speech, sentence types, punctuation
39	Reader	Ostriches (400-word decodable passage)
40	Assessment	Final mastery check

Daily Routine Reference

Every Lesson Has These Components

1. **Phonogram flash review** — 2-5 minutes. Child sees card, says ALL sounds in frequency order.
2. **New learning** — Introduce ONE concept. Never two new things in one lesson.
3. **Spelling Analysis** — The heart of the lesson. 5-step routine (hear-segment-write-analyze-read).
4. **Reading practice** — Decodable words and sentences using known phonograms.
5. **Quick check** — Verify understanding before moving on.

Spelling Analysis (Every Lesson)

Step	Teacher	Student
1. Hear & Say	Say word. Use in sentence.	Repeat.

Step	Teacher	Student
2. Segment	Hold up fingers (1 per sound).	Break word into sounds.
3. Write	Watch student write.	Write phonograms.
4. Analyze	"What rules? Underline multi-letter PGs."	Identify phonograms + rules.
5. Read	"Read it sound by sound, then blend."	Sound out, then blend.

Say-to-Spell (Stages 3+)

For any word with schwa: say word normally → pronounce with clear vowels → segment → write → read normally.

Materials Checklist

Must Print/Prepare

- [] Phonogram cards: all 75 (26 single + 49 multi-letter) — print from any PG lesson
- [] Spelling rules poster: <reference/spelling-rules.html>
- [] Spelling Analysis routine poster: <reference/spelling-analysis.html>
- [] Phonogram chart: <reference/phonogram-chart.html>
- [] Quickstart cheat sheet: <reference/quickstart.html>
- [] Whiteboard + marker (one per student)
- [] Sand tray (Stage 1 handwriting practice)

Nice to Have

- [] Morpheme wall: <reference/morpheme-wall.html> (Stages 4-5)
- [] Word lists: <reference/word-lists.html> (extra practice)

- [] HF words reference: <reference/high-frequency-words.html>
- [] Lesson PDFs: Generate with `python framework/render.py --all`

For Each Lesson

- [] Phonogram cards for review
- [] Printed lesson OR open the markdown file on a tablet
- [] Whiteboard/marker
- [] Pencil and paper (Stage 2+)

Pacing Guide

Stage	Age	Lessons/Week	Weeks	Total Time
1	4-5 (Pre-K)	3-4	12-16	20-30 weeks
2	5-6 (K)	4-5	11-14	30-36 weeks
3	6-7 (Gr 1)	4-5	11-14	30-36 weeks
4	7-8 (Gr 2)	4-5	10-12	30-36 weeks
5	8+ (Gr 3+)	4-5	8-10	20-25 weeks

Total: approximately 2-3 school years for the full curriculum. Older students can move faster.

Assessment Checkpoints

Assessment	Lesson	What It Checks
Stage 1 mastery	Lesson 48	All a-z sounds, CVC blending/segmenting, sound identification

Assessment	Lesson	What It Checks
Stage 2 mid	Lesson 24	First 8 multi-letter PGs, CVC/CCVC spelling, Rules 26 + 3
Stage 2 final	Lesson 56	26 multi-letter PGs, short/long vowels, blends, 6 rules
Stage 3 mid	Lesson 24	Silent E 1-4, first 5 new PGs, Rules 1-2
Stage 3 final	Lesson 56	All 9 SE reasons, 17 new PGs, syllable division, 9 rules
Stage 4 mid	Lesson 13	Schwa, Rules 13-14, say-to-spell
Stage 4 final	Lesson 48	Suffixing, Latin /sh/, morphology, 6 more rules
Stage 5 final	Lesson 40	25 roots, fluency (WPM), composition, grammar

Passing score: 85%+ on each assessment. If lower, review weak areas for 1-2 weeks and retest.

Troubleshooting Quick Reference

Problem	Likely Cause	Fix
Child can't blend CVC	Not enough PA practice	Return to Stage 1, lessons 6-7
Mixes up b/d, p/q	Visual confusion	Separate by at least 1 week; use multi-sensory tracing
Guesses at words instead of sounding out	Sight word habit	Go back to sound-by-sound; no guessing allowed
Can't remember phonogram sounds	Not enough flash review	5 min daily flash drill. Say ALL sounds each time.
Spells 'mak' for 'make'	Silent E not internalized	Return to Stage 3, lesson 3. Practice the reason.
Says /ā/ for 'a' in 'cat'		

Problem	Likely Cause	Fix
	Taught short sound after long	Always teach ALL sounds from the start.
Reads robotically (no fluency)	Needs repeated reading practice	Use Stage 5 fluency passages; time and re-read.
Can't spell multi-syllable words	Not using say-to-spell	Model say-to-spell for EVERY schwa word.

More in: <reference/troubleshooting.html>

Command Reference

Generate all lesson PDFs

```
python framework/render.py --all
```

Generate one stage

```
python framework/render.py --stage 3
```

Generate single lesson

```
python framework/render.py lessons/stage-2/pg-sh.md
```

Generate curriculum PDF

```
python framework/render.py --curriculum
```

Check which images are missing

```
python framework/image-check.py
```

Generate image prompts for missing images


```
python framework/image-check.py --prompts
```

```
# Regenerate lesson stubs from catalog
```

```
python scripts/generate-stage1.py    # Stage 1
```

```
python scripts/generate-stage2.py    # Stage 2
```

```
# ... etc for stages 3-5
```

Philosophy Reminders

1. **Speech-to-print, not print-to-speech.** Start with the sound, find the written form.
2. **Teach ALL sounds from the start.** Never say "a says /ă/" — always say "a says /ă/ /ā/ /ä/."
3. **Spelling drives reading.** Spelling Analysis is the core routine.
4. **No sight words.** Every word can be explained with phonograms and rules.
5. **Say-to-Spell is not optional.** Schwa appears in the majority of multi-syllable words. Without say-to-spell, the child cannot hear the spelling.
6. **Never skip phonemic awareness.** Even if the child knows letters, sound discrimination is the foundation.
7. **One new thing per lesson.** Never introduce two phonograms or two rules in one lesson.